

Wednesday, July 27

Cheryl will pick Peter up on the way to his swimming lessons. With Matthew alone, the schedule more than relaxes. He woke at 7, we ate breakfast by 7:40. Cheryl cleaned and sewed. I worked in the basement. Things were uninterrupted until Cheryl left for Peter. The bank phoned. The woman seemed quite angry. "The supervisor has been getting irritated by your deficit account - 500 dollars to date. Would you please be in this afternoon." Our tax money has run out. Fortunately I deposit my July cheque tomorrow. Hopefully the bank will finger Cheryl and continue to see me as the straight man with the best intentions to keep the trust of powerful corporate entities.

Cheryl was in the living room as Peter and Matthew played. Matthew cried suddenly.

Cheryl asked, "What happened Peter?"

"I hurt Matthew."

Cheryl said nothing.

Peter continued. "Do you know why I hurt Matthew?"

"No."

"I love him so much."

"I don't see the sense in that."

"But on Mama's record it says that we often hurt those we love the most."

Later, Peter told Cheryl that her hair 'looked very good today'. We're not quite sure what he meant. When I came home from swimming Peter was at the door with a wrapped box and two white envelopes. I opened his card. This card, signed by him, had been bought some time ago by Cheryl. His choice, made sometime later, was a card with a dog urinating on a fire hydrant. He thought it was a perfectly natural expression of his feeling for me, as something that might happen on one's birthday, or at any other time.

Crystal came to sit for us. Cheryl and I left the house at 7:30 for supper and a movie. Things didn't stick to the plan however. Cheryl needed eyedrops to stop the tears of chlorine-burned eyes. She insisted we return to Lathey to find a gold hoop earring she lost while swimming that day. Then we went to supper and a movie. Supper was pizza at Ryden's Deli in Bedford Square. This is a casual place with a long serving counter in front that displays meats, health drinks and menus. At the back are two rows of small round tables and chairs. Pizza cartons are stacked against the wall beside an orange bathtub/sofa with a side cut out for sitting pleasure. There is little efficiency and less service. Asking for anything, and it seems to be a first-time-ever experience for the waiter. Two fellows talk the request over with each other, think a little, then come up with a solution. However, in most restaurants, the longer you sit the less service-minded they become. Here, as the dinner lengthens the friendliness increases. The pizza and coffee were good. We ate Nanaimo bars in the car. The movie, *Survivors*, was playing in Towne Cinema next to a 3-D movie called *The Swedish Butler*. I suppose neither show will be recalled very long from now. Robin Williams, Walter Mathau and Jerry Reed, each victims of New York City's crushing sadism, struggled through a satirical expression of the individual's ego and insularity. We laughed, Cheryl harder than I expected, especially at the scene of the bandaged Williams looking as if a plate of spaghetti had been dumped on him.